

Part A – Case Study: Cyberbullying

What it is: Cyberbullying is the repeated, intentional use of digital platforms—social media, messaging apps, or gaming forums—to harass, intimidate, or humiliate an individual. Unlike physical bullying, it can occur 24/7 and spreads rapidly to a vast audience, leaving a permanent digital footprint.

How it typically happens :

1. **The Trigger:** A student, "Kavya," expresses a personal view in a college forum. A group of classmates takes offense and decides to "troll" her.
2. **The Escalation:** The group creates a "burn page" on Instagram specifically to mock Kavya. They use AI tools to create "deepfake" or manipulated images of her in compromising situations.
3. **Doxing & Mobbing:** Her private phone number is leaked in the comments. Within hours, she receives hundreds of abusive WhatsApp messages and anonymous "threat calls" from strangers.
4. **Social Exclusion:** The bullies use the fake narrative to convince her real-life friends to block her, effectively isolating her both digitally and physically.

Who is targeted: It primarily targets **teenagers and college students** who are highly active online. Individuals who stand out due to their opinions, appearance, or background are often disproportionately targeted.

Consequences: For the victim, the consequences include **severe psychological trauma**, chronic anxiety, and depression. In many cases, it leads to "academic paralysis," where the victim is too terrified to attend classes. Legally, perpetrators in India can be prosecuted under **Sections 66E, 67, and 67A of the IT Act**, which can lead to imprisonment and heavy fines.